

TEACHER'S COPY • NOT FOR STUDENTS

# Batman's Treaty: where each number goes

The board is one A3 sheet per pair, the cards two A4 sheets per pair. The same twenty sentences are listed underneath in number order.

|                                      | Grade 5 | Year 6 | Year 7 | Year 8 | Year 9 |
|--------------------------------------|---------|--------|--------|--------|--------|
| ■ Origin, features & purpose         | 19      | 6      | 11     | 16     | 3      |
| ▲ Historical context                 | 10      | 17     | 15     | 5      | 7      |
| ● Historical interpretations         | 12      | 14     | 8      | 20     | 1      |
| ◆ Accuracy, usefulness & reliability | 2       | 4      | 13     | 9      | 18     |

- 1

the two documents disagree because they were written for different purposes, one to justify a land claim, one to control it
- 2

useful for showing what people wore and carried
- 3

Burt's 1875 painting, made forty years later for people who had not seen it happen
- 4

it cannot tell us what the Kulin people actually thought
- 5

In the 1830s, Britain claimed Australia belonged to no one, so land could not legally be bought from its people
- 6

painting of Batman's meeting with the Kulin Nation
- 7

The meeting sits inside a bigger argument: colonists wanted land, while British law increasingly held that Aboriginal people could not sell land they were said not to own
- 8

Batman's own deed, the paper in his hand in the painting, says the Kulin people agreed to sell
- 9

it cannot be trusted as a record of what was said or agreed, because the artist was not there
- 10

the day Batman said he bought Kulin land
- 11

a later artwork by John Wesley Burt, made about forty years afterwards to record the meeting
- 12

The Proclamation disagrees
- 13

it was painted forty years later, by someone who was not there
- 14

Batman claimed the Kulin people agreed to sell their land
- 15

Batman wanted land, and colonists were arguing about whether buying land from Aboriginal people was even allowed
- 16

Burt's 1875 artwork of Batman's 1835 meeting with the Kulin Nation
- 17

remember an event some colonists were proud of
- 18

weak evidence of what actually happened, since no Kulin account of the day survives
- 19

blankets with gifts on them
- 20

the painting takes neither side, it simply shows the meeting happening